

Session 8: Creating More & More Value

Summary:

One of the big obstacles we'll need to overcome to create more and more value is a mechanism inside each of us. I call it The Justice Mechanism. Us humans like it when things are "fair" and "just." This means we like it when we get as much as everyone else, or just a little bit more. But this mechanism keeps us average. If you want to play a bigger game, you must get over this Justice Mechanism.

For example, if you're selling eBooks online, one way to super-charge your business is to give away your very best technique for free. This creates a buzz, builds your email list at lightning speed, and inspires everyone to think, "If her free stuff is this good, how much better must her paid stuff must be!" To give away techniques for free that you've spent years creating - to do this "unjust" thing - requires that you temporarily get over your Justice Mechanism. This is what's necessary for massive success.

Short term thinking is another thing we must get over. It's like an addiction or disease. And because everyone is doing it, it never occurs to us that it's not the thing that'll take us to where we want to go. When you do something that is designed to create a long term effect, it usually doesn't look attractive in the short term. Think of a bamboo tree. It spends 3 years growing its roots under ground. There's no growth above ground during this entire time. But after 3 years, all of a sudden when the root network is established, the tree will start growing up to 3 feet per DAY. Crazy growth. In the short term, it looked like nothing was happening. But in the long term, a miracle occurred. Long term actions look unimpressive in the short term. Accept this.

One of the questions I ask myself is, "What is value?" Value is a result of a process that happens inside of human beings. We value some things over other things. As you develop your talent into strength and put it to work to create value, start looking around for what other people find valuable. This will be your guide. Look at what people do in your role to create the most value. Remember that success is an indirect game - focus on creating more value, and the income will come. Focus on getting income, and it limits your value creation ability. Stop using income as a goal, and instead just see it as a measure of the value you created. It's not the main objective, but a byproduct of your main objective.

There are a few key things you want to do on a regular basis to increase your value creation ability:

1. **Timeliness:** Be on time. Deliver on time. If you're not going to be on time, let people know before hand.
2. **Consistency:** Deliver consistent results. Show consistent emotional stability.
3. **Quality:** Do a little bit extra. Make it perfect. Add the little flourish or flare that lets people know your product is created with quality.

Exercise:

1. Identify what is considered highly valuable in the industry you want to be in. Do this by talking to 3 experts in the industry, and 3 customers of the industry.

Ask each of them:

1. What's your biggest problem or frustration?
2. What's your biggest desire or want? This will tell you where to focus your energies in your career.

Helping people avoid what they don't want, and get what they do want, is the road to massive value creation and success.